As for what Fergusson called ‘*Chaitya* caves’: ‘These are the temples, or if I may use the expression, the churches of the series, and one or more of them is attached to every set of caves in the west of India, though none exist in the eastern side.’

One curious feature of this Buddhist rock-cut architecture was the way it imitated in stone features of contemporary wooden structures, so that the vaulted ceilings of the caves incorporated quite unnecessary beams, and the doorways and window frames echoed the decorated horse-shoe shapes of wooden buildings shown on bas-reliefs. Even when the caves were later enlarged to serve as *chaitya-griha*s or prayer-halls these archaic features persisted.

Fergusson’s paper also included an account of the Ellora caves, which were unusual in being a mix of ten Buddhist caves, six Jain and four of what Fergusson called Brahminical. However, these last had been cut centuries later than the others and were quite different in conception. Instead of burrowing into the rock from the side the masons had started at the top, working downwards to carve magnificent temples out of the solid rock, no longer as monastic retreats but as sites of popular worship, with the vast Kailas temple at Ellora the supreme example, conceived on a quite stupendous scale: ‘Every thing is Brahminical, every thing is copied from structural buildings; and had it been cut out of a rock on a plain, no stranger would have suspected that it was a monolith, without at least a most careful examination of its structure … Whatever faults may be inherent in the design, we owe to it the most splendid excavation in India.’